Hamas would release the women and children it is still holding as hostages in exchange for a given number of Palestinian prisoners. There is no doubt that the hostages are a major asset in the entire Hamas strategy.

Saturday, December 9/Sunday, December 10

Netanyahu will do everything to keep his hard-right coalition in power. He now plays the role of tough guy; he doesn't miss an opportunity of being photographed in uniform, with troops; he may reject Biden's deadline and show his "mettle" by pursuing the war in Gaza against the whole world, when the reasonable aim is not to eradicate Hamas but to make sure that it does not rule Gaza any more. He will do anything to push away the trial for corruption that awaits him. His son Yair has received a diplomatic passport …

It occurs to me that Netanyahu may wish to contribute to Biden's difficulties with the progressives and to Trump's electoral victory.

The US administration bypasses Congress and sells 14,000 rounds of tank ammunition to Israel in an emergency deal.

The war with Hezbollah is heating up. It seems that from the outset, Defense Minister Gallant has been intent to fight the Iranian-led organization with full force. Why? In the South, the suffering of the civilian population is not abating.

Monday, December 11

Today the details of Netanyahu's enormous strategic mistake regarding Hamas came to light in the *New York Times*. For years, the PM encouraged Qatari payments to Gaza to keep the enclave quiet and build up a counterweight to the Palestinian Authority in the West Bank: that is, to hinder the possibility of a Palestinian state. Of course, part of the money